the other, went their different ways. Little did they realize then that within a few months both the armies would get embroiled in a war over Kashmir. My grandfather, whose battalion, the 1/67 Punjabis, was similarly divided, was quite heartbroken about this and once remarked, 'The "paltan" that was built by our blood, sweat and toil over a century or two, disintegrated overnight with the stroke of the pen of the Mulki Laat, the Viceroy!'

It was a time of great stress for my parents. Between March 1946 and February 1948, my father, who was just a captain, was shunted around to eight different military stations in various units! So was the case with a large number of commissioned officers and men too. Things would never be the same again for officers and men of the British Indian Army. The effect was traumatic as well as tragic in many cases, particularly for those soldiers and their families who happened to suddenly find themselves living in the wrong country.